

Hotel California -- Eagles

Hotel California, 1976. ~74 BPM.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

Randy Meisner is on bass for the studio cut. The part is a warm, round, laid-back groove with a slight reggae lilt that sits behind the beat under the 12-string intro and the verses.

The famous Felder/Walsh dual-guitar outro gets a fuller, pushed bass under it.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Apg115 IR (User IR 1)

Apg115 is the Ampeg B-15 1x15, the classic 70s studio bass amp. Its 100Hz peak gives the warm girth this part needs.

Classic Bass is the same Ampeg family and the suggested pairing.

- Gain: 28. Clean.
- Bass: 62. Warm and full.
- Middle: 50, MidFreq: 450Hz. Low-mid body, not snap.
- Treble: 42. Round, mid-70s LA studio tone.
- VOL: 65. CAB VOL: 60.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 12. Light, so the laid-back note tails stay natural.

PRE -- COMP (Ross), always on.

Sustain: 45, VOL: 60.

Smooth studio-style leveling for the relaxed groove.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 18, Blend: 30, VOL: 60, Bass: 55, Treble: 48.

A light push for the outro. More weight and presence under the twin guitars, not audible distortion.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. Gain 28, Bass 62, Middle 50, MidFreq 450Hz, Treble 42, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 1 (Apg115), always on. VOL 60.

EQ -- Bass EQ 2, always on.

50Hz: +3, 120Hz: +2, 400Hz: 0, 800Hz: +1, 4.5kHz: -2, VOL: 52.

Warm low end, a bit of 800Hz so the syncopated notes still read, top rolled off.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- Plate, on CTL.

Mix: 18, Decay: 40, Damp: 50, Trail: on.

A smooth plate matches the polished 70s studio sheen once the outro opens up. Damp 50 keeps the tail from getting splashy on bass.

CTL footswitch

Two modules on CTL: DST (Bass OD) and RVB (Plate).

- **CTL off**: intro, verses, and choruses. Warm, round, dry, behind the beat. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on**: the dual-guitar outro solo. Light push plus plate for a fuller bed under the harmony leads.

Engage when the outro solo starts and leave it on to the fade.